

In, On, At: time vs place

CEFR A2

Lesson Pack · summary, worksheet & answer key

Quick answer

in, on and at cover both time and place with the same logic:

- 1 at — the most precise: at 6 o'clock / at the door.
- 2 on — a day or a surface: on Monday / on the table.
- 3 in — a longer period or an enclosed space: in July / in the box.

Think small → big: at (point) → on (day/surface) → in (period/space).

At a glance

	at (point)	on (day / surface)	in (period / space)
Time	at 6 o'clock, at night	on Monday, on 5 May	in July, in 2025, in the morning
Place	at the door, at home	on the table, on the wall	in the box, in London

Learning objectives

- Can apply the small-to-big logic of at/on/in to both time and place (CEFR A2).
- Can select the right preposition in mixed time-and-place contexts.
- Can recall the key fixed exceptions.



Practice worksheet

Circle the correct option. In, On, At: time vs place · CEFR A2

Name: _____

Date: _____

1. TIME: The shop opens ____ 9 o'clock.

- | | |
|-------|-------|
| A. at | B. on |
| C. in | D. — |

2. PLACE: Someone is ____ the door.

- | | |
|-------|-------|
| A. at | B. on |
| C. in | D. — |

3. TIME: We're meeting ____ Saturday.

- | | |
|-------|-------|
| A. on | B. at |
| C. in | D. — |

4. PLACE: The notice is ____ the board.

- | | |
|-------|-------|
| A. on | B. at |
| C. in | D. — |

5. TIME: It's very cold ____ December.

- | | |
|-------|-------|
| A. in | B. on |
| C. at | D. — |

6. PLACE: The children are playing ____ the garden.

- | | |
|-------|-------|
| A. in | B. on |
| C. at | D. — |

7. TIME: I usually read ____ night.

- | | |
|-------|-------|
| A. at | B. in |
| C. on | D. — |

8. PLACE: I'm ____ home this evening.

- | | |
|-------|-------|
| A. at | B. in |
| C. on | D. — |

9. Correct this: 'The meeting is in Monday in 3 p.m.'

- | | |
|---------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| A. The meeting is on Monday at 3 p.m. | B. The meeting is at Monday on 3 p.m. |
| C. The meeting is in Monday at 3 p.m. | D. The meeting is on Monday in 3 p.m. |

10. What's the small-to-big order of these prepositions?

- | | |
|-----------------|-----------------|
| A. at → on → in | B. in → on → at |
| C. on → at → in | D. at → in → on |

Answer key

Correct answers with explanations · for the teacher

1. **A. at** — A precise time takes 'at': 'at 9 o'clock'.
2. **A. at** — A point takes 'at': 'at the door'.
3. **A. on** — Days take 'on': 'on Saturday'.
4. **A. on** — A surface takes 'on': 'on the board'.
5. **A. in** — Months take 'in': 'in December'.
6. **A. in** — An area/enclosed space takes 'in': 'in the garden'.
7. **A. at** — 'At night' is a fixed expression.
8. **A. at** — 'At home' is a fixed expression.
9. **A. The meeting is on Monday at 3 p.m.** — Day = 'on Monday', clock time = 'at 3 p.m.'
10. **A. at → on → in** — at (most precise) → on (day/surface) → in (broadest).